RESOLUTION No.7206

Resolution Proclaiming the Celebration of National Native American Indian Heritage Month in Portland Public Schools

RECITALS

A. Native American and Alaska Native peoples are descendants of the original, Native American inhabitants of what is now the United States.
B. The Portland Metro region rests on the traditional lands of the Bands of the Chinook, Multnomah, Clackamas, Tualatin, Molalla, Kalapuya, Wasco, Cowlitz, and Kathlamet Indian tribes. These tribes established thriving communities in a region rich with natural resources, sustaining their families through fishing, trading, and harvesting. In the 1950s, under the Federal Relocation Policy, many Native people across the U.S. were forced to relocate to major cities—including Portland—adding to the diversity of tribal representation in the region. Today, Portland is home to one of the largest and most diverse urban Native American populations in the country.
C. The history of Native American and Alaska Native peoples is rich with individuals who have positively influenced and enriched our nation, our state, and our schools through entrepreneurship, community service, cultural and artistic contributions, and a deep commitment to justice and liberty.
D. On August 3, 1990, President George H. W. Bush declared the month of November as National American Indian Heritage Month—now commonly referred to as Native American Heritage Month.
E. Native American and Alaska Native peoples have made and continue to make profound contributions in education, medicine, art, culture, public service, and beyond, serving as a vital and enduring influence in our nation's growth and prosperity.
F. The Portland Metro Native American community is diverse and growing, with an estimated population of nearly 70,000. As a relocation site, Portland Public Schools (PPS) proudly serves students representing more than 150 tribal nations. PPS honors and is deeply grateful for the contributions of Native American students, families, staff, and community members to the district's mission and collective success.
G. Understanding Native American history is an essential part of celebrating Native American Heritage Month and building awareness, respect, and appreciation for Native American cultures and perspectives.
H. In 2017, the Oregon Legislature passed Senate Bill 13, *Tribal History/Shared History*, introduced by the Oregon Indian Education Association and signed into law by Governor Kate Brown. The law directed the Oregon Department of Education (ODE) to develop a statewide curriculum on the Native American experience in Oregon, including tribal history, sovereignty, culture, treaty rights, government, and contemporary issues.
I. Tribal History/Shared History is one the objectives identified in ODE's American Indian/Alaska Native State Plan, ensuring that every Oregon school district implements historically accurate, culturally embedded, place-based, and developmentally appropriate curriculum about Oregon's nine federally recognized tribes.
J. The Portland Public Schools Board of Education believes that every student should be celebrated and appreciated for their unique and vibrant cultural contributions. The Board honors and celebrates Native American students, families, and communities for their enduring strength, knowledge, and leadership.

RESOLVED

1. The Portland Public Schools Board of Education hereby proclaims November 1 through November 30 as Native American Indian Heritage Month, and encourages all staff, students, and community members to observe, recognize, and celebrate the culture, heritage, and lasting contributions of Native American and Alaska Native peoples to Oregon and the United States.
2. The Board further encourages schools and departments to engage in culturally relevant learning, reflection, and activities that honor Native voices, learn from the past, and deepen understanding of the experiences that continue to shape our shared history and future.